A STUDY ON THE IMPACT OF QUICK COMMERCE ON PURCHASING BEHAVIOUR OF URBAN CONSUMERS

In partial fulfilment of the requirements of the Undergraduate Programme in B. Com.

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This dissertation has not been submitted previously by me or any other person for the award of any degree, diploma, or other academic recognition. All the sources of information used in this study have been appropriately acknowledged.

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CHAPTER I

INTRODUCTION

1.1 Introduction

The Indian retail ecosystem has undergone a series of transformative shifts over the last two decades, moving from unorganized neighborhood stores to organized retail chains, and subsequently to e-commerce platforms that redefined convenience through home delivery. The most recent and arguably the most disruptive shift within this continuum is the emergence of quick commerce, a retail format that compresses the delivery window for everyday consumer goods to a matter of minutes rather than days. Quick commerce, commonly abbreviated as q-commerce, refers to the delivery of groceries, packaged foods, personal care items and household essentials within an extremely short time frame, typically ranging from ten to thirty minutes of order placement.

The genesis of quick commerce in India can be traced to the rising expectations of urban consumers accustomed to instant gratification in nearly every sphere of digital life, from streaming entertainment to ride-hailing services. Platforms such as Blinkit (formerly Grofers), Zepto, Swiggy Instamart and BigBasket Now capitalized on this expectation by building a network of small, strategically located dark stores or micro-fulfilment centers within dense urban neighborhoods. This hyperlocal inventory model, combined with algorithm-driven logistics and a fleet of delivery partners, has allowed these platforms to compress delivery timelines that were previously considered technically and economically unfeasible.

The rapid proliferation of smartphones, affordable mobile data and digital payment infrastructure in India has created fertile ground for this business model to flourish, particularly in

metropolitan and tier-1 cities where population density supports the economics of dark-store operations. Industry estimates suggest that the quick commerce sector in India has grown at a compound annual growth rate that far outpaces traditional e-commerce grocery delivery, with continued expansion anticipated into tier-2 cities as well. This growth has not been limited to metropolitan hubs alone; it has begun to penetrate smaller urban centers, altering purchasing habits across a wider demographic base.

From a consumer behaviour standpoint, the rise of quick commerce raises important questions regarding how instant access to products influences the psychology of purchase decisions. Traditional consumer behaviour theory places considerable emphasis on the deliberation process that precedes a purchase, encompassing need recognition, information search, evaluation of alternatives, and post-purchase evaluation. Quick commerce, by virtue of collapsing the time between need recognition and product acquisition, potentially compresses or even bypasses several of these stages, giving rise to more impulsive and habitual purchasing patterns. Understanding this shift is essential not only for academic inquiry into consumer psychology but also for businesses seeking to design product assortments, pricing strategies and user interfaces that align with this evolving behaviour.

This study seeks to examine these dynamics empirically by surveying urban consumers regarding their usage patterns, motivations, spending behaviour and satisfaction levels with respect to quick commerce platforms, thereby contributing to a more grounded understanding of how this retail innovation is reshaping everyday consumption in urban India.

1.2 Current Scenario

The quick commerce industry operates on a fundamentally different logistical architecture compared to conventional e-commerce. While traditional online retailers rely on centralized warehouses located on the outskirts of cities, quick commerce companies establish a dense network of small dark stores, often no larger than a few thousand square feet, positioned within a two-to-four-kilometer radius of the customers they serve. Each dark store carries a curated inventory of high-velocity items, ranging from fresh produce and dairy products to snacks, beverages, personal care products and household essentials, selected based on localized demand patterns and purchase history data.

The competitive intensity within this sector has been considerable, with major players investing heavily in expanding their dark-store footprint, optimizing delivery-partner routing algorithms, and offering aggressive discounts and promotional schemes to acquire and retain customers. Partnerships and consolidation activity within the sector, along with the entry of larger conglomerates into the space, indicate that quick commerce is increasingly viewed as a strategically important segment of the broader retail and technology industry rather than a niche experiment.

Beyond groceries, the scope of quick commerce has gradually expanded to include categories such as electronics accessories, medicines, cosmetics, stationery, and even ready-to-eat meals, reflecting an effort by platforms to increase the average order value and the frequency of consumer engagement. This category expansion is itself an important area of interest for understanding how consumer expectations regarding delivery speed gradually permeating categories are well beyond the original grocery-led proposition. A more detailed account of the industry’s operational model,

growth trajectory and regulatory environment is presented in the theoretical framework in Chapter Three.

1.3 Significance of the Study

This study holds significance for multiple stakeholders. For academic researchers, it contributes to the growing body of literature on digital consumer behaviour by providing primary data specific to the quick commerce context, a relatively recent phenomenon that has not yet been as extensively studied as conventional e-commerce or brick-and-mortar retail. For quick commerce operators and marketers, the findings offer practical insight into the factors that drive platform adoption, the categories most susceptible to impulsive purchasing, and the areas of dissatisfaction that could be addressed to improve customer retention.

For policymakers and urban planners, an understanding of how quick commerce is reshaping consumption patterns and physical retail footfall carries implications for urban commercial real estate, employment within the gig economy, and consumer protection considerations related to data privacy and pricing transparency. Finally, for consumers themselves, a study of this nature can help raise awareness of behavioral patterns such as impulsive spending that may not always be consciously recognized, encouraging more mindful consumption.

1.4 Statement of the Problem

While quick commerce has achieved rapid market penetration and considerable media attention, there remains limited academic and empirical understanding of precisely how this format influences the underlying purchasing behaviour of the urban consumers who use it. Existing literature and industry commentary tend to focus on the operational and logistical aspects of quick commerce, such as dark-store economics, delivery-fleet management and unit economics, while comparatively less attention has been paid to the consumer-side implications, including changes

in spending patterns, impulsive buying tendencies, brand and platform loyalty, and the displacement of traditional retail habits.

This creates a gap in understanding that is of relevance both to academic researchers studying consumer behaviour in the digital economy and to industry practitioners seeking to design products and marketing strategies that resonate with evolving consumer expectations. The problem this study addresses, therefore, is the need for an empirically grounded assessment of how urban consumers perceive, use and are influenced by quick commerce platforms in their day-to-day purchasing decisions.

1.5 Objectives of the Study

The present study has been undertaken with the following objectives:

1. To understand the extent and frequency of usage of quick commerce platforms among urban consumers.
2. To identify the primary motivations that drive urban consumers to adopt quick commerce services over traditional retail and conventional e-commerce.
3. To examine the impact of quick commerce on the overall spending behaviour and average order value of urban consumers.
4. To assess the influence of quick commerce on impulsive purchasing tendencies among consumers.
5. To evaluate the extent to which quick commerce has affected consumer footfall at physical retail stores.
6. To measure the level of consumer satisfaction with existing quick commerce services and identify areas for improvement.
7. To offer suggestions to quick commerce companies for enhancing consumer engagement and addressing identified gaps.

1.6 Scope of the Study

The scope of this study is confined to urban consumers who have used or are aware of quick commerce platforms such as Blinkit, Zepto, Swiggy Instamart and BigBasket Now. The study covers respondents across different age groups, genders and occupational backgrounds residing in urban and semi-urban localities. It focuses specifically on the behavioral and attitudinal dimensions of quick commerce usage, namely frequency of use, spending patterns, product preferences, satisfaction levels and the perceived impact on physical retail visits, rather than on the operational, financial or logistical aspects of the companies themselves. The study is based on primary data collected through a structured questionnaire from a sample of 66 respondents, supplemented by secondary data drawn from industry reports, academic articles and market research publications relevant to the quick commerce sector.

1.7 Research Methodology

Research methodology refers to the systematic and logical framework adopted for conducting a research study, encompassing the research design, the method of data collection, the sampling procedure, and the tools employed for data analysis and interpretation. This section outlines the methodological approach adopted for the present study on the impact of quick commerce on the purchasing behaviour of urban consumers.

1.7.1 Research Design

This study adopts a descriptive research design, which is appropriate for studies that aim to describe the characteristics, attitudes and behaviour of a population with respect to a particular phenomenon, in this case, the usage of quick commerce platforms. Descriptive research is well suited to this study as the primary objective is not to establish causal relationships between

variables but rather to systematically document and interpret the prevailing patterns of consumer behaviour, preferences and satisfaction levels in relation to quick commerce. The study is largely quantitative in nature, relying on a structured questionnaire to elicit responses that can be statistically summarized and interpreted.

1.7.2 Type and Source of Data

Primary data for this study was collected directly from urban consumers through a structured questionnaire designed specifically for the purposes of this research, administered in an online format to facilitate a wider geographic reach and to accommodate the convenience of respondents. Secondary data was drawn from a range of sources, including academic journal articles, industry and market research reports published by consulting firms, company websites and press releases of quick commerce platforms, and reputed business news publications. This secondary data was used primarily to construct the review of literature and the theoretical framework, to provide context on the growth and structure of the quick commerce industry, and to support the interpretation of primary findings.

1.7.3 Sampling Design and Sample Size

The population for this study comprises urban consumers who have used, or are familiar with, quick commerce platforms such as Blinkit, Zepto, Swiggy Instamart and BigBasket Now. A convenience sampling technique, a form of non-probability sampling, was adopted for this study, owing to its practicality and cost-effectiveness within the time constraints of the study, allowing the researcher to reach respondents who were readily accessible and willing to participate through an online questionnaire circulated across personal and professional networks and social media platforms. The study is based on responses collected from a sample of 66 urban respondents. While

this sample size is modest in scale, it was considered adequate for the exploratory and descriptive objectives of the present study, allowing for meaningful percentage-based analysis of response patterns across the various dimensions examined.

1.7.4 Data Collection Instrument

A structured questionnaire comprising a combination of demographic questions and questions relating to quick commerce usage behaviour was designed for the purpose of primary data collection. The questionnaire was divided broadly into two sections: the first section captured demographic information such as age group and gender, while the second section captured behavioral and attitudinal information relating to frequency of usage, platform preference, spending patterns, product category preferences, impact on physical retail visits, importance of delivery speed, influence of discounts, impulsive buying tendencies, overall satisfaction, and expectations for future improvement. Most questions were structured in a single-response, multiple-choice format to facilitate ease of response and subsequent quantitative analysis. The complete questionnaire used for data collection is provided in the Appendix of this report.

The final sample of 66 respondents reflects a reasonably diverse cross-section of urban consumers in terms of both age and gender, as detailed further in the demographic analysis presented in Chapter Four. The sample is weighted towards younger respondents, with the 18–25 years age bracket forming the single largest cohort, consistent with the generally younger skew of the early and core adopter base for app-based, on-demand retail services, while gender representation remains close to evenly balanced. While the sample was not stratified to proportionally represent India’s broader urban population by city tier, income bracket or

occupation, the diversity achieved across age and gender provides a reasonably solid empirical base for the descriptive objectives pursued in this study.

1.7.5 Questionnaire Design, Pilot Testing and Validity

The questionnaire was designed with reference to constructs identified during the review of literature, including convenience orientation, impulsive buying tendency, price sensitivity and satisfaction. Prior to full-scale circulation, the draft questionnaire was shared with a small group of five respondents drawn from the researcher's immediate academic and professional network, in order to conduct a brief pilot test aimed at identifying any ambiguity in question wording, assessing the average time required to complete the questionnaire, and confirming that the response options provided for each question were exhaustive and mutually exclusive. Minor refinements were made to the wording of two questions following this pilot exercise. Content validity was ensured by grounding each question in constructs already established within the consumer behaviour literature, while face validity was further supported through the pilot testing exercise. Given the descriptive, single-administration nature of this study, formal test-retest reliability measures were not computed; however, the internal consistency of response patterns, discussed in Chapter Four, lends reasonable confidence to the coherence of the data collected.

1.7.6 Method of Administration and Ethical Considerations

The finalized questionnaire was created using an online survey form and circulated digitally through channels including social media platforms, messaging applications and academic networks, allowing the researcher to reach a geographically dispersed set of urban respondents within the available time frame. Respondents were required to complete each question before proceeding to the next, ensuring a fully complete dataset with no missing value across any of the

fifteen survey items. Participation in the survey was entirely voluntary, and respondents were informed at the outset that their responses would be used solely for academic research purposes and would be kept confidential. No personally identifiable information was collected, ensuring the anonymity of individual respondents, and no incentive or compensation was offered for participation, thereby minimizing the possibility of response bias arising from an expectation of reward.

1.7.7 Statement of Working Assumptions

In line with the descriptive and exploratory nature of this study, the research was guided by a set of broad working assumptions rather than formally tested statistical hypotheses, given the categorical nature of the data and the modest sample size involved. These working assumptions were as follows: first, that a majority of urban respondents would report frequent usage of quick commerce platforms, reflecting the format's growing integration into routine consumption; second, that fast delivery and convenience would emerge as the dominant motivations for platform adoption, ahead of price-based considerations; third, that a meaningful proportion of respondents would report a reduction in physical retail visits attributable to quick commerce adoption; and fourth, that a majority of respondents would report engaging in impulsive purchasing behaviour on quick commerce platforms. The extent to which the primary data collected supports or qualifies each of these working assumptions is discussed in the analysis presented in Chapter Four and synthesized in the findings presented in Chapter Five.

1.7.8 Tools and Formula for Data Analysis

The data collected through the questionnaire was compiled in a structured format and analyzed using percentage analysis, a widely used descriptive statistical technique that expresses

the frequency of responses to each question as a proportion of the total number of respondents. This method was considered appropriate given the categorical, single-response nature of the survey items and the descriptive objectives of the study. The percentage analysis presented in Chapter Four was computed using the standard formula set out below:

$$\textit{Percentage of Respondents (\%)} = (\textit{Number of Respondents Selecting a Given Option} \div \textit{Total Number of Respondents}) \times 100$$

This formula was applied uniformly across all fifteen questions in the survey instrument, with the total number of respondents (N = 66) serving as the denominator in each case, given that the questionnaire was designed such that every respondent was required to answer every question, resulting in a complete dataset with no missing responses. The resulting distributions were represented graphically through pie charts to aid visual interpretation, with the analyzed data presented question-by-question in Chapter Four.

1.7.9 Framework for Interpretation

In interpreting the percentage distributions presented in Chapter Four, response categories carrying similar directional meaning have, where appropriate, been aggregated to draw broader conclusions. For instance, in questions employing a five-point ordinal scale such as frequency or level of agreement, the two most favorable categories have generally been combined to comment on the overall proportion of respondents leaning towards a particular position, while the two least favorable categories have similarly been combined to comment on the extent of disagreement or dissatisfaction. This approach follows standard practice in the interpretation of Likert-type and ordinal survey data within descriptive consumer research.

1.7.10 Period and Scope of the Methodology

The study, including the design of the questionnaire, the pilot test, the collection of primary data, and the subsequent analysis and interpretation of findings, was conducted over a defined academic project period as prescribed under the guidelines of the program of study, with the primary data collection phase completed within approximately three to four weeks. It should be noted that, owing to the use of a non-probability convenience sampling technique, the findings of this study are best interpreted as indicative of behavioral patterns within the sampled population rather than as statistically generalizable estimates applicable to the entire universe of urban quick commerce users. Nonetheless, the consistency of the response patterns observed across related questions, discussed further in Chapters Four and Five, lends reasonable confidence to the broad behavioral conclusions drawn from this study.

1.8 Limitations of the Study

As with any empirical research undertaking, this study is subject to certain limitations that should be considered while interpreting its findings.

1. The sample size of 66 respondents, while adequate for an exploratory descriptive study, is relatively modest and may not fully represent the diversity of urban consumers across India.
2. The study relies on self-reported data collected through a structured questionnaire, which is subject to recall bias and the possibility of respondents providing socially desirable rather than entirely accurate answers.
3. The research was conducted within a limited time frame, which constrained the scope for a longitudinal analysis of behavioral change over time.
4. The findings are more reflective of urban and digitally literate consumers who already have some degree of familiarity with quick commerce platforms and may not extend to rural or less digitally connected populations.

5. The study does not account for platform-specific operational variables such as pricing algorithms, inventory availability or delivery-partner incentive structures, which may independently influence consumer experience.

1.9 Chapterisation Scheme

Chapter 1: Introduction

Chapter 2: Review of Literature

Chapter 3: Theoretical Framework

Chapter 4: Data Analysis and Interpretation

Chapter 5: Findings, Suggestions, Recommendations and Conclusions

CHAPTER 2

REVIEW OF LITERATURE

2.1 Introduction

A review of existing literature is essential to situate the present study within the broader body of knowledge on consumer behaviour, retail innovation and digital commerce. This chapter examines the conceptual underpinnings of quick commerce, traces its evolution as an extension of e-commerce and online grocery retail, reviews consumer behaviour theories relevant to understanding impulsive and convenience-driven purchasing, and surveys empirical studies that have examined related phenomena in both Indian and global contexts. The chapter concludes by identifying the specific research gap that the present study aims to address.

2.2 Conceptual Framework of Quick Commerce

Quick commerce can be conceptually positioned as an evolution of online grocery and convenience retail, distinguished primarily by its delivery time promise. Whereas conventional e-commerce platforms typically commit to delivery windows ranging from a few days to a week, and same-day delivery services narrow this to a matter of hours, quick commerce compresses the fulfilment cycle to minutes. This is made operationally possible through the dark-store model, wherein small-format, hyperlocal warehouses stocked with fast-moving consumer goods are positioned within close proximity to residential clusters.

The conceptual appeal of quick commerce rests on what marketing scholars often describe as the "convenience premium," the willingness of consumers to pay a marginally higher price or accept a smaller basket size in exchange for the elimination of waiting time and the reduction of

purchase-related effort. This aligns with broader theories of consumer convenience orientation, which suggest that as disposable income and time scarcity both rise in urban populations, consumers increasingly value solutions that minimize the time and cognitive effort required to fulfil routine needs.

2.3 Evolution of E-Commerce and Online Grocery Retail

The trajectory of e-commerce in India has moved through several distinct phases, beginning with the early 2000's emergence of horizontal marketplaces for books and electronics, followed by the rapid expansion of fashion and lifestyle e-commerce in the 2010's, and subsequently the growth of online grocery delivery platforms that sought to digitize the traditionally offline and highly fragmented grocery retail sector. Online grocery delivery faced early challenges related to thin margins, complex supply chains for perishable goods, and consumer reluctance to purchase fresh produce without physical inspection.

Quick commerce emerged as a response to these challenges by narrowing the geographic radius of operation, thereby reducing spoilage and enabling tighter inventory control, while simultaneously addressing consumer hesitation through the promise of near-instant fulfilment that reduced the perceived risk of running out of essential items. This evolutionary link between online grocery and quick commerce is important for situating the present study, as it suggests that quick commerce should not be viewed purely as a novel technology but as an incremental, albeit disruptive, refinement of an existing retail digitization trajectory.

2.4 Consumer Behaviour Theories Relevant to Quick Commerce

2.4.1 The Traditional Consumer Decision-Making Process

Classical consumer behaviour models describe purchasing as a sequential process comprising need recognition, information search, evaluation of alternatives, purchase decision and post-purchase evaluation. This framework assumes a degree of deliberation on the part of the consumer, particularly during the information search and evaluation stages. Quick commerce, by design, minimizes the friction associated with these intermediate stages: product discovery, comparison and checkout are compressed into a single, streamlined mobile application experience, often accompanied by algorithmically generated recommendations that pre-empt the need for extensive search.

2.4.2 Impulsive Buying Behaviour

Impulsive buying is generally defined in marketing literature as an unplanned purchase characterized by a relatively sudden and often emotionally driven decision to buy, typically without extensive prior deliberation. Several antecedents of impulsive buying have been identified in prior research, including situational factors such as time pressure and product availability, as well as individual traits such as an inclination towards novelty-seeking and hedonic consumption. Quick commerce platforms, through the constant visibility of instant delivery options, time-bound discount notifications, and frictionless one-tap ordering, create an environment that is conducive to impulsive purchasing. This makes the study of impulsive buying tendencies particularly relevant to understanding the consumer-behaviour implications of quick commerce adoption.

2.4.3 Convenience Orientation and Time Poverty

The concept of time poverty, referring to the perception among urban working populations that they have insufficient time to accomplish desired tasks, has been widely discussed in relation to the growth of on-demand services more broadly, including ride-hailing, food delivery and instant messaging. Quick commerce can be viewed as a direct response to this perceived time scarcity, offering a value proposition centered not on price but on the minimization of the time and effort required to fulfil routine household needs. Consumers with a strong convenience orientation are theorized to place a disproportionately high value on such time-saving attributes, even at a marginal cost premium.

2.4.4 Habit Formation and Platform Loyalty

Habitual behaviour, characterized by automatic responses to contextual cues with minimal conscious deliberation, is another relevant construct. Repeated positive experiences with a quick commerce platform, reinforced through consistent delivery speed and reliability, can lead to the formation of habitual usage patterns, wherein the consumer defaults to a particular platform for routine purchases without actively comparing alternatives each time. This has implications for platform loyalty and customer lifetime value within the quick commerce industry.

2.5 Review of Related Empirical Studies

A number of industry reports and academic studies have examined aspects of the quick commerce phenomenon, both within India and in comparable international markets. Industry research reports published by consulting and market intelligence firms have consistently highlighted the rapid growth trajectory of the quick commerce sector in India, attributing this growth to rising urbanization, increasing smartphone and internet penetration, and changing

lifestyle patterns, particularly among working professionals and dual-income households in metropolitan cities.

Academic studies examining online grocery adoption prior to the emergence of quick commerce identified convenience, time-saving and perceived usefulness as significant predictors of consumer intention to adopt online grocery shopping, drawing on established technology-acceptance frameworks. These findings provide a useful baseline against which the incremental influence of quick commerce's speed proposition can be assessed. More recent studies focusing specifically on instant delivery services have begun to document a rise in impulsive purchasing associated with such platforms, alongside concerns regarding the sustainability of deep discount strategies used for customer acquisition and the working conditions of gig-economy delivery personnel.

Studies examining the impact of digital retail formats on traditional brick-and-mortar stores have generally found a gradual, rather than abrupt, displacement effect, with consumers continuing to visit physical stores for certain categories such as bulk purchases, fresh produce requiring physical inspection, and social or experiential shopping occasions, while shifting routine and top-up purchases to digital and quick commerce channels. This nuanced displacement pattern is of direct relevance to one of the objectives of the present study, which examines the extent to which quick commerce has affected physical retail visits among the surveyed respondents.

Within the specific Indian context, industry surveys conducted by e-commerce and retail-focused research organizations have consistently reported that urban millennial and Gen-Z consumers rank speed and convenience above price as the primary driver of platform choice within the quick commerce category, a finding that stands in some contrast to the price-sensitivity

traditionally associated with the broader Indian retail consumer. At the same time, these same surveys note that price sensitivity re-emerges as a secondary but still significant consideration once basic speed and convenience expectations are met, suggesting a layered hierarchy of consumer priorities that the present study's own findings, discussed in Chapter Four, appear to corroborate.

2.6 Research Gap

While the existing body of literature provides valuable insight into the operational growth of the quick commerce sector and the general theoretical underpinnings of convenience-driven and impulsive consumer behaviour, there remains a relative scarcity of empirical, survey-based studies that directly examine urban consumer attitudes, spending behaviour and satisfaction levels specifically in relation to quick commerce platforms, as distinct from online grocery or e-commerce more broadly. Much of the available commentary is either industry-generated market sizing data, which does not capture behavioral nuance, or theoretical extrapolation from adjacent domains such as food delivery and ride-hailing.

The present study seeks to address this gap by collecting and analyzing primary data directly from urban consumers regarding their quick commerce usage patterns, motivations, spending behaviour, impulsive buying tendencies, and satisfaction levels, thereby contributing empirically grounded evidence to a domain that has, until now, been discussed largely at the level of industry trend commentary.

2.7 Summary of Literature Review

The literature reviewed in this chapter collectively establishes that quick commerce represents an evolutionary extension of online grocery retail, distinguished primarily by its radically

compressed delivery window and enabled by the dark-store operational model, digital payments infrastructure, and near-universal smartphone penetration among urban Indian consumers. Established consumer behaviour theories relating to convenience orientation, impulsive buying and habit formation provide a robust theoretical foundation for anticipating that quick commerce, by compressing the traditional consumer decision-making journey, is likely to be associated with increased impulsive purchasing, higher discretionary spending, and a gradual displacement of routine physical retail visits. However, as identified in the research gap above, empirical, survey-based evidence directly examining these behavioral effects among urban Indian consumers remains limited, a gap that the present study seeks to address through the primary data analysis presented in Chapter Four. The operational, regulatory, comparative and theoretical dimensions of quick commerce are examined further in the theoretical framework presented in Chapter Three.

CHAPTER 3

THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK

3.1 The Dark Store Model and Its Operational Underpinnings

Central to the functioning of quick commerce is the dark store, a small-format warehouse that is closed to walk-in customers and functions exclusively as a fulfilment point for online orders. Unlike a conventional retail outlet, a dark store is designed purely for storage efficiency and rapid order-picking rather than for browsing or in-store customer experience. Dark stores are typically located within densely populated residential neighborhoods, allowing delivery partners to reach customers within a two-to-four-kilometer radius in a matter of minutes.

The inventory carried within each dark store is curated on the basis of localized demand data, meaning that two dark stores operated by the same company in different neighborhoods may carry meaningfully different product assortments depending on the demographic and purchasing profile of the surrounding population. This hyperlocal customization is enabled by sophisticated demand-forecasting algorithms that continuously analyse historical order data, time-of-day patterns, seasonal trends and even weather conditions to optimize stock levels and minimize both stockouts and spoilage of perishable goods.

The order-fulfilment process itself has been engineered for speed at every stage. Upon an order being placed through the mobile application, an automated system assigns the nearest dark store with the required inventory, and a warehouse associate, guided by a picking algorithm that sequences the physical layout of the store for efficiency, assembles the order within a target window of two to three minutes. The order is then handed to a delivery partner, typically waiting at or near the dark store, who is guided by route-optimization software to the customer’s location.

This entire sequence of algorithmic assignment, picking and delivery is what enables the compressed delivery windows that define the quick commerce proposition.

3.2 Growth Trajectory and Market Size

Industry estimates place the Indian quick commerce market among the fastest-growing segments of the country's broader retail and e-commerce economy, with reported compound annual growth rates considerably outpacing those of conventional online grocery and general e-commerce categories over the past three to four years. This growth has been fueled by a combination of demand-side factors, including rising urban disposable incomes, increasing participation of women in the urban workforce, and growing nuclear-family household structures that place a premium on time-saving solutions, alongside supply-side factors such as the availability of abundant venture capital funding directed towards building out dark-store networks and delivery infrastructure at scale.

While early growth was concentrated almost entirely within India's largest metropolitan centers, namely Delhi NCR, Mumbai, Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Chennai, Pune and Kolkata, more recent expansion has extended into tier-2 cities such as Jaipur, Lucknow, Indore, Chandigarh and Coimbatore, reflecting both the saturation of quick commerce penetration within top-tier metros and a strategic push by platforms to capture the next wave of urban consumers. This geographic broadening is significant for the present study, as it suggests that the behavioral patterns examined here, while drawn primarily from an urban sample, are likely to become increasingly representative of a wider cross-section of India's urban and semi-urban population over time, rather than remaining confined to a narrow metropolitan elite.

Investor and analyst commentary on the sector has also highlighted a gradual shift in strategic emphasis, from a purely growth-at-any-cost approach centered on aggressive customer acquisition and deep discounting, towards a greater focus on unit economics, dark-store profitability and sustainable order density. This shift is likely to have downstream implications for the consumer experience, potentially manifesting as more selective discounting, greater emphasis on delivery-charge structures, and continued investment in expanding product assortment to increase average order values, several of which are themes that emerge directly from the primary data analyzed in Chapter Four of this report.

3.3 Consumer Demographics Driving Adoption

The consumer base for quick commerce in India has traditionally skewed towards younger, digitally native urban professionals and students, a pattern that is broadly reflected in the demographic composition of the sample surveyed for this study, discussed in detail in Chapter Four. This demographic cohort is characterized by high smartphone usage, comfort with digital payments, dual-income or single working-professional household structures, and a general orientation towards convenience-based consumption across multiple categories of daily life, including food delivery, ride-hailing and entertainment streaming, in addition to grocery and household shopping.

At the same time, industry commentary and the present study's own findings suggest a gradual broadening of the adopter base to include older urban consumers, particularly in the 36–45 years and above-45 years age brackets, who may initially have been introduced to app-based ordering through family members and subsequently developed independent usage habits. This broadening adoption curve is consistent with well-established patterns of technology diffusion

observed in other digital services, wherein early adoption among younger, more tech-forward segments is gradually followed by wider mainstream adoption as platforms mature, interfaces become more intuitive, and social proof accumulates within extended family and community networks.

3.4 Quick Commerce within the Indian Retail Landscape

India's retail sector has historically been dominated by unorganized, small-format outlets, commonly referred to as Kirana stores, which continue to account for a substantial majority of overall retail trade despite the steady growth of organized retail chains and, more recently, e-commerce over the past two decades. The neighborhood Kirana store has traditionally offered several advantages that proved resilient in the face of organized retail competition, including proximity to the consumer's residence, the extension of informal credit to regular customers, and the flexibility to sell in small, non-standard quantities suited to daily household consumption patterns.

Quick commerce, in a sense, directly targets precisely these historical advantages of the Kirana store, replicating and in some respects surpassing the proximity advantage through its dense dark-store network, while replacing informal credit relationships with digital payment convenience and loyalty-based discounting. This direct competitive overlap with the Kirana segment, more so than with larger organized retail formats such as supermarkets and hypermarkets, is an important contextual consideration for interpreting the finding, discussed in Chapter Four, that a majority of respondents report reduced visits to physical retail stores since adopting quick commerce.

At the same time, several quick commerce operators have begun exploring partnership and aggregator models that seek to integrate, rather than entirely displace, small Kirana retailers into their hyperlocal fulfilment networks, recognizing the deep market knowledge, existing customer relationships and real-estate footprint that these small retailers already possess. The long-term equilibrium between outright displacement and integrative partnership remains an evolving and contested question within the Indian retail policy discourse, and one that extends beyond the immediate scope of this consumer-behaviour-focused study.

3.5 Key Challenges Facing the Quick Commerce Sector

Despite its rapid growth, the quick commerce sector continues to grapple with several structural challenges that have important implications for its long-term sustainability and, by extension, for the consistency of the consumer experience examined in this study. Chief among these is the challenge of achieving profitable unit economics at the level of the individual dark store, given the substantial fixed costs associated with real estate, inventory holding and a dedicated delivery-partner workforce, set against the comparatively low average order values that characterize much of the category, as documented in the primary data presented in Chapter Four. Achieving sufficient order density within each dark store's catchment area to offset these fixed costs remains an ongoing operational priority for most players in the sector.

A second significant challenge relates to the management and retention of the delivery-partner workforce upon whom the entire ultra-fast fulfilment promise depends. High attrition rates among delivery partners, driven in part by the physically demanding and time-pressured nature of the work, require platforms to continuously invest in recruitment and training, while also

navigating an evolving regulatory and public discourse around gig-worker classification, minimum earnings guarantees and social security benefits in several Indian states.

A third challenge concerns the sustainability of promotional and discounting strategies used to acquire and retain customers. As observed in several international markets discussed later in this chapter, quick commerce operators have faced investor pressure to demonstrate a credible path to profitability, often necessitating a scaling back of aggressive discounting. Given the strong influence of discounts on purchasing decisions documented among respondents in this study, any such recalibration of promotional intensity carries a meaningful risk of dampening consumer engagement, underscoring the delicate balance that quick commerce operators must strike between growth, profitability and sustained customer satisfaction.

3.6 Digital Payments and the Enabling Ecosystem

The growth of quick commerce in India cannot be examined in isolation from the parallel evolution of the country's digital payments infrastructure. The widespread adoption of the Unified Payments Interface (UPI) and the corresponding decline in cash-on-delivery as a preferred payment mode have significantly reduced friction at the checkout stage of quick commerce transactions. Prior literature on e-commerce adoption in emerging markets has consistently identified payment-related friction, including distrust of online payment security and a preference for cash transactions, as a significant barrier to online purchase adoption. The near-universal availability of secure, instant digital payment options has removed much of this friction, allowing quick commerce platforms to offer genuinely one-tap ordering experiences that further reduce the time and cognitive effort separating need recognition from purchase completion.

Similarly, the proliferation of affordable smartphones and low-cost mobile data plans has expanded the addressable base of consumers capable of engaging with app-based commerce. This infrastructural convergence, encompassing payments, connectivity and device penetration, forms an essential backdrop against which the specific behavioral phenomenon of quick commerce adoption must be understood, as it is this convergence that has made the near-instantaneous, friction-free purchase experience technically and economically feasible at scale.

3.7 Comparative Perspectives from Global Markets

While the present study focuses on the Indian context, it is useful to briefly situate the phenomenon within a global comparative perspective, as quick commerce has emerged, with varying degrees of success, in several international markets. In Western Europe, companies pioneered the ten-minute grocery delivery model in dense urban centers, drawing considerable venture capital investment during the period of low interest rates that preceded a broader industry-wide correction. Several of these companies subsequently faced consolidation pressures, scaling back operations or merging with competitors as investors demanded clearer paths to profitability, highlighting the challenging unit economics that can underline the quick commerce business model when dark-store density and delivery-fleet utilization are not optimized.

In several Southeast Asian and Middle Eastern markets, quick commerce has often been introduced as an extension of existing ride-hailing or food-delivery super-app ecosystems, leveraging existing delivery-partner networks and customer bases rather than being built as a standalone vertical. This comparative pattern is instructive for the Indian context as well, where the strong performance of Swiggy Instamart observed in the present study's findings can be partly

attributed to precisely this kind of ecosystem leverage, drawing on Swiggy's pre-existing base of food-delivery customers and delivery infrastructure.

These comparative observations suggest that the long-term sustainability of quick commerce as a business model depends significantly on achieving sufficient order density within a given dark-store catchment area, a consideration that, while primarily operational in nature, has direct behavioral implications: platforms are strongly incentivized to encourage frequent, habitual ordering among a loyal user base, which in turn reinforces the very impulsive and habitual purchasing patterns that this study seeks to examine.

3.8 Ethical and Societal Considerations

The academic and policy discourse surrounding quick commerce has also raised a number of ethical and societal considerations that, while not the direct focus of this study, provide useful context for interpreting its findings. Concerns have been raised regarding the working conditions of gig-economy delivery partners, who often operate under considerable pressure to meet the compressed delivery windows that define the sector, raising questions about occupational safety and fair compensation. Additionally, the impact of dark-store proliferation on urban commercial real estate and on the livelihoods of small, traditional Kirana store owners has attracted attention from policymakers and industry commentators alike.

From a consumer welfare perspective, the deliberate design of app interfaces to encourage frequent engagement and impulsive purchasing, sometimes referred to in behavioral design literature as the use of "dark patterns," raises questions about the ethical boundaries of persuasive technology design. While a detailed examination of these design practices is beyond the scope of the present study, the empirical finding, discussed in Chapter Four, that a majority of respondents

engage in frequent impulsive purchasing on quick commerce platforms lends contextual relevance to this broader area of concern.

3.9 Regulatory and Policy Environment

The regulatory environment governing quick commerce in India spans several overlapping domains, including foreign direct investment norms applicable to e-commerce and multi-brand retail, labour and gig-worker welfare regulations, food safety and standards compliance for perishable grocery items, and, increasingly, data protection and consumer privacy legislation. Existing foreign direct investment regulations governing e-commerce marketplaces, originally framed with conventional online retail in mind, have at various points required clarification as to their applicability to the dark-store-based inventory model employed by quick commerce operators, given that this model sits somewhat differently along the spectrum between a pure marketplace and an inventory-led retail operation compared to earlier e-commerce formats.

On the labour front, several Indian states have introduced or proposed legislation aimed at extending social security benefits, minimum earnings protections and accident insurance coverage to gig and platform workers, a category that includes the delivery partners central to quick commerce fulfilment. The evolving nature of this regulatory landscape represents an important area of ongoing change for the sector, with direct cost implications for platform operators that may, in turn, influence pricing, delivery-charge structures and promotional strategies that shape the very consumer experience examined in this study.

Additionally, the introduction of comprehensive data protection legislation in India carries implications for how quick commerce platforms collect, store and utilize the granular location and purchase-history data that underpins their hyperlocal, personalized service model. Compliance

with such legislation may require platforms to introduce more explicit consent mechanisms and greater transparency around data usage, developments that, while outside the direct scope of the present consumer-behaviour-focused study, form part of the broader operating context within which the behavioral patterns documented in Chapter Four are situated.

3.10 Quick Commerce versus Traditional E-Commerce: A Comparative View

While quick commerce is often discussed as a natural extension of e-commerce, a closer comparison reveals several dimensions along which the two formats differ meaningfully, with direct implications for consumer behaviour. Traditional e-commerce platforms typically operate on a centralized or regional warehouse model, carrying a vastly wider assortment of stock-keeping units than any individual quick commerce dark store, and are correspondingly better suited to planned, considered purchases involving product comparison, reading of reviews, and evaluation of multiple alternatives before checkout. Quick commerce, by contrast, offers a comparatively narrow assortment curated for immediacy and high purchase frequency, and is correspondingly better suited to replenishment-style and impulse-driven purchase occasions.

This difference in assortment breadth and purchase occasion has a direct bearing on the applicability of the traditional consumer decision-making process discussed in Chapter Two. Whereas a traditional e-commerce purchase, particularly for considered categories such as electronics or apparel, still typically involves some degree of the information-search and alternative-evaluation stages, even if compressed relative to offline shopping, a quick commerce purchase for a routine or impulse item frequently skips these stages altogether, with the consumer proceeding almost directly from need recognition, or even mere exposure to a promotional cue, to purchase completion. This distinction reinforces the rationale for treating quick commerce as a

behaviorally distinct phenomenon warranting dedicated empirical attention, rather than simply as a faster variant of existing e-commerce.

A further point of distinction lies in the frequency and regularity of engagement that each format tends to generate. Traditional e-commerce purchases, particularly for considered or big-ticket categories, tend to be relatively infrequent, occurring perhaps a handful of times per month for an active user. Quick commerce, by virtue of its low per-order value and near-instant fulfilment, is capable of generating engagement on a daily or even multiple-times-daily basis for its most active users, a pattern that is reflected in the usage-frequency data presented in Chapter Four of this report. This higher frequency of engagement has implications not only for platform economics but also for the psychological entrenchment of habitual purchasing patterns discussed in the review of habit-formation literature in Chapter Two.

3.11 Consumer Trust and Risk Perception in Quick Commerce

Consumer trust has long been recognized as a critical determinant of adoption in digital retail contexts, given the inherent information asymmetry between buyer and seller in a transaction that does not permit physical inspection of the product prior to purchase. In the quick commerce context, trust concerns have historically centered on product freshness, particularly for perishable categories such as fruits, vegetables and dairy products, as well as on the accuracy of product substitutions made by warehouse staff when a specific stock-keeping unit is unavailable at the time of order fulfilment.

Platforms have sought to address these trust concerns through mechanisms such as photographic verification of packed orders prior to dispatch, easy and often no-questions-asked return or refund policies for unsatisfactory items, and transparent display of expiry dates for

perishable goods within the application interface. The relatively high overall satisfaction levels reported by respondents in this study, discussed in Chapter Four, suggest that these trust-building mechanisms have, on the whole, been reasonably effective in addressing early consumer skepticism regarding product quality assurance in an unseen, rapidly fulfilled transaction.

Risk perception in the quick commerce context also extends to considerations of data privacy, given the granular location and purchase-history data that such platforms necessarily collect in order to power their hyperlocal, personalized service model. While a detailed examination of data privacy attitudes falls outside the scope of the present study, it remains a relevant consideration for the continued evolution of consumer trust in this sector, particularly as regulatory frameworks around data protection continue to develop within the Indian context.

3.12 Theoretical Models Applied to the Study

3.12.1 The AIDA Model

The AIDA model, one of the most enduring frameworks in marketing and advertising literature, describes the consumer journey as progressing through four sequential stages: Attention, Interest, Desire and Action. Applied to the quick commerce context, this framework offers a useful lens for understanding how platforms design their in-app experience to move consumers rapidly through each stage within a single, uninterrupted session. Attention is typically captured through push notifications and prominently displayed time-bound offers upon opening the application; interest is sustained through personalized product recommendations informed by past purchase history; desire is cultivated through visually appealing product imagery and scarcity cues such as limited-time discounts; and action is facilitated through a frictionless, one-tap checkout process supported by saved payment credentials. The compression of this entire journey into a matter of

minutes, as opposed to the days or weeks that might separate these stages in traditional retail contexts, is a defining characteristic of the quick commerce consumer experience and is directly relevant to understanding the high incidence of impulsive purchasing documented in this study.

3.12.2 The Stimulus-Organism-Response (S-O-R) Model

The Stimulus-Organism-Response model, widely used in environmental psychology and subsequently adapted to online retail research, posits that external stimuli present within a retail environment, whether physical or digital, influences an individual's internal cognitive and emotional states, which in turn produce an observable behavioral response. Within the quick commerce context, stimuli include the visual design of the mobile application, the prominence of countdown timers indicating estimated delivery time, and the framing of promotional discounts. These stimuli are theorized to generate internal organismic states such as urgency, excitement or a fear of missing out on a limited-time offer, which subsequently manifest as behavioral responses including impulsive add-to-cart actions, increased basket size, or repeat app visits. The S-O-R framework provides a useful theoretical scaffold for interpreting the strong influence of discounts and the high incidence of impulsive purchasing reported by respondents in Chapter Four of this study.

3.13 Consumer Segmentation within the Quick Commerce User Base

Emerging industry and academic commentary on quick commerce has begun to identify distinct behavioral segments within the broader user base, moving beyond simple demographic classification towards a more nuanced, needs-based segmentation. One commonly discussed segment comprises "emergency users," who turn to quick commerce primarily to address unplanned, urgent requirements, such as running out of a staple item mid-week or needing

medication outside regular pharmacy hours, and who consequently exhibit relatively low but consistent order frequency. A second segment, often termed "convenience loyalists," consists of consumers who have substituted a meaningful share of their routine, planned grocery and household shopping onto quick commerce platforms, exhibiting high order frequency and a preference for platform loyalty program.

A third segment, of particular relevance to the present study, can be described as "deal seekers" or "promotion-driven users," who are primarily motivated by discounts and promotional offers rather than by delivery speed or convenience per se, and who may exhibit lower platform loyalty, readily switching between competing applications based on the prevailing promotional calendar. A fourth and increasingly discussed segment comprises "impulse browsers," who engage with quick commerce applications not necessarily in response to an identified need but as a form of casual browsing behaviour, similar to scrolling through a social media feed, and who consequently exhibit a disproportionately high incidence of unplanned, impulsive purchases.

While the present study did not set out to formally cluster respondents into these behavioral segments, given the constraints of sample size and the descriptive scope of the research design, the response patterns documented in Chapter Four, particularly the substantial overlap between respondents motivated by discounts and those reporting frequent impulsive purchasing, suggest that elements of both the "deal seeker" and "impulse browser" segments are well represented within the surveyed sample. This observation may be a useful starting point for future, more granular segmentation-focused research, as discussed further in the scope for future research presented in Chapter Five.

3.14 Conclusion

This chapter has set out the theoretical and operational framework within which the present study is situated, covering the dark-store fulfilment model, the sector's growth trajectory and demographic base, its position within the broader Indian retail landscape, the structural challenges and enabling ecosystem that shape its evolution, comparative international experience, the regulatory environment, and the consumer-behaviour theories, namely the AIDA model, the Stimulus-Organism-Response model and behavioral segmentation frameworks, that inform the interpretation of consumer responses to quick commerce. Together with the review of literature presented in Chapter Two, this framework provides the conceptual foundation against which the primary data analyzed in Chapter Four is interpreted.

CHAPTER 4

DATA ANALYSIS AND INTERPRETATION

4.1 Introduction

This chapter presents the analysis and interpretation of the primary data collected from 66 urban respondents through the structured questionnaire described in Chapter Three. The data pertaining to each question has been tabulated, expressed in percentage terms, represented graphically through pie charts, and accompanied by a brief interpretation highlighting the key observations.

The collected data are organized and analyzed using appropriate statistical and graphical techniques. The major techniques include:

1. Percentage Analysis

Percentage analysis is used to determine the proportion of respondents belonging to different response categories.

$$\text{Percentage} = \frac{\text{Number of Respondents}}{\text{Total Number of Respondents}} \times 100$$

2. Frequency Distribution

Frequency tables are prepared to present the number of respondents selecting each response option.

4. Graphical Representation

The findings are presented using suitable **bar charts, pie charts and other graphs** to make the results easier to understand and interpret.

4.2 Age Group of Respondents

The first question sought to determine the age distribution of the respondents who participated in the survey, in order to understand the demographic composition of the sample.

Table 4.1: Age Group of Respondents

Age Group	Number of Respondents	Percentage
Below 18 years	12	18.2%
18–25 years	26	39.4%
26–35 years	12	18.2%
36–45 years	7	10.6%
Above 45 years	9	13.6%
Total	**66**	**100.0%**

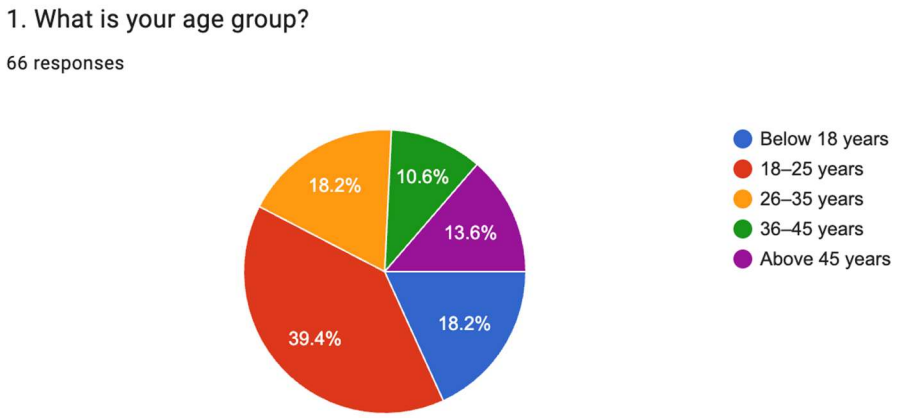


Fig. 4.a: Age Group of Respondents

The data reveals that the largest proportion of respondents, at 39.4 per cent, falls within the 18–25 years age bracket, indicating that the sample is dominated by young adults, a demographic segment widely recognized as being highly receptive to digital-first retail formats.

4.3 Gender of Respondents

The second question captured the gender distribution of the respondents to ensure a balanced understanding of usage patterns across genders.

Table 4.2: Gender of Respondents

Gender	Number of Respondents	Percentage
Male	30	45.5%
Female	31	47.0%
Prefer not to say	3	4.5%
Other	2	3.0%
Total	**66**	**100.0%**

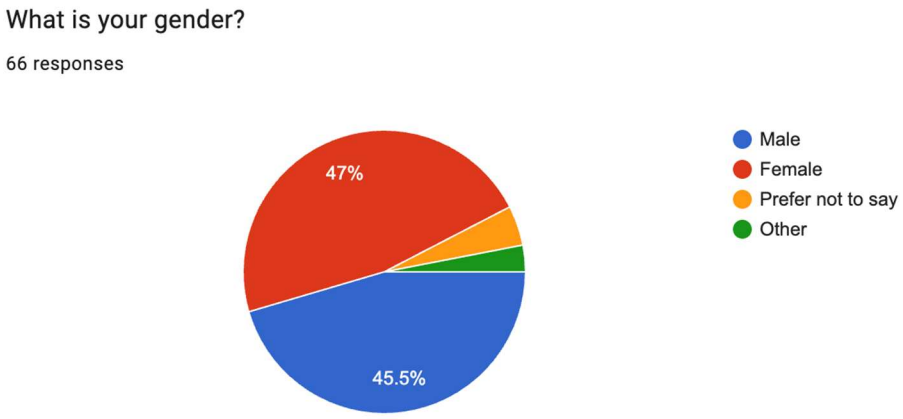


Fig. 4.b: Gender of Respondents

The gender distribution of the sample is fairly balanced, with female respondents constituting 47.0 per cent and male respondents 45.5 per cent of the total sample.

4.4 Frequency of Usage of Quick Commerce Platforms

This question examined how frequently respondents use quick commerce platforms such as Blinkit, Zepto, Swiggy Instamart or BigBasket Now.

Table 4.3: Frequency of Usage of Quick Commerce Platforms

Frequency of Usage	Number of Respondents	Percentage
Daily	12	18.2%
Several times a week	14	21.2%
Once a week	20	30.3%
Rarely	13	19.7%
Never	7	10.6%
Total	**66**	**100.0%**

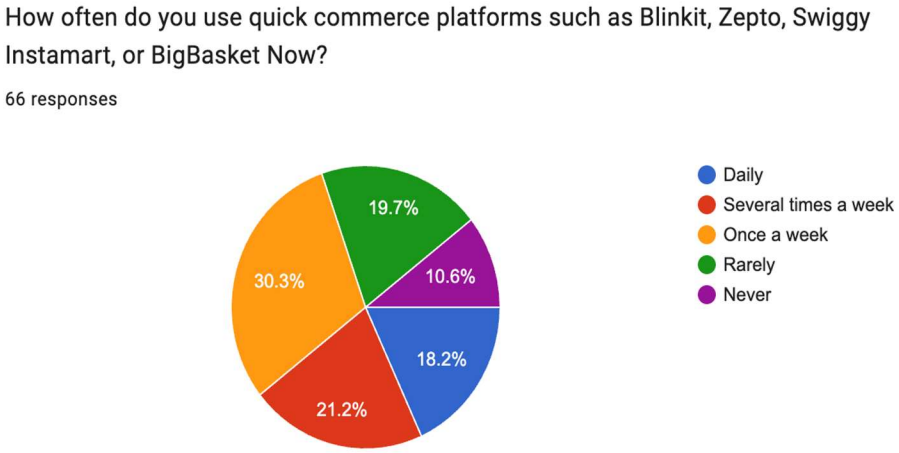


Fig. 4.c: Frequency of Usage of Quick Commerce Platforms

The data indicates that a substantial majority of respondents, nearly 69.7 per cent, use quick commerce platforms at least once a week, with 30.3 per cent using them weekly, 21.2 per cent several times a week, and 18.2 per cent on a daily basis.

4.5 Most Frequently Used Platform

Respondents were asked to identify the quick commerce platform they use most frequently, in order to gauge relative platform preference.

Table 4.4: Most Frequently Used Quick Commerce Platform

Platform	Number of Respondents	Percentage
Blinkit	10	15.2%
Zepto	7	10.6%
Swiggy Instamart	26	39.4%
BigBasket	6	9.1%
Other platforms	17	25.8%
Total	**66**	**100.0%**

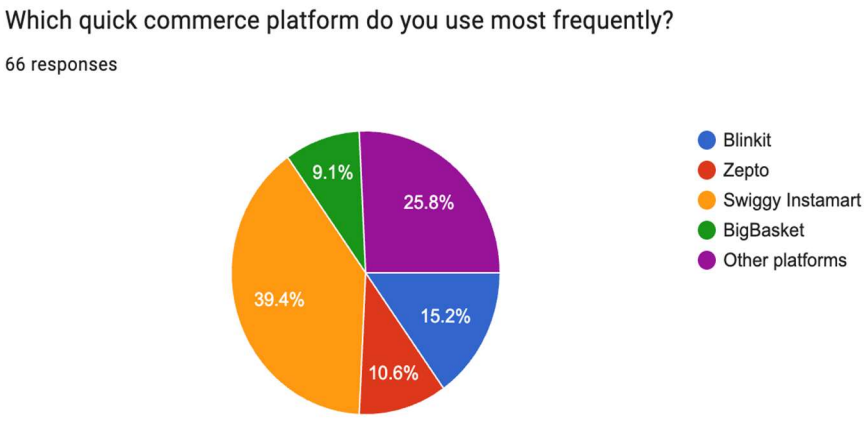


Fig. 4.d: Most Frequently Used Quick Commerce Platform

Swiggy Instamart emerges as the most preferred platform among respondents, capturing 39.4 per cent of the sample. Blinkit follows at 15.2 per cent, while Zepto and BigBasket account for 10.6 per cent and 9.1 per cent respectively.

4.6 Primary Reason for Using Quick Commerce Services

Table 4.5: Primary Reason for Using Quick Commerce Services

Reason	Number of Respondents	Percentage
Fast delivery	18	27.3%
Convenience	14	21.2%
Discounts and offers	14	21.2%
Wide product availability	10	15.2%
Emergency or urgent requirements	10	15.2%
Total	**66**	**100.0%**

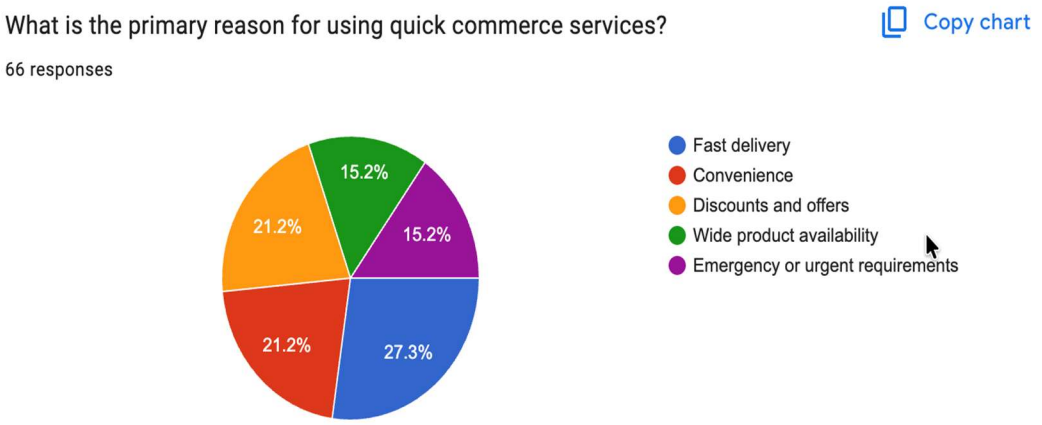


Fig. 4.e: Primary Reason for Using Quick Commerce Services

Fast delivery stands out as the single most cited reason for using quick commerce, selected by 27.3 per cent of respondents, reaffirming that speed remains the core value proposition of this retail format. Convenience and discounts and offers are tied as the second most important motivators, each accounting for 21.2 per cent of responses.

4.7 Average Spend on a Single Quick Commerce Order

Table 4.6: Average Spend on a Single Quick Commerce Order

Spend Range	Number of Respondents	Percentage
Below ₹200	15	22.7%
₹200–₹500	19	28.8%
₹501–₹1,000	16	24.2%
₹1,001–₹2,000	11	16.7%
Above ₹2,000	5	7.6%
Total	**66**	**100.0%**

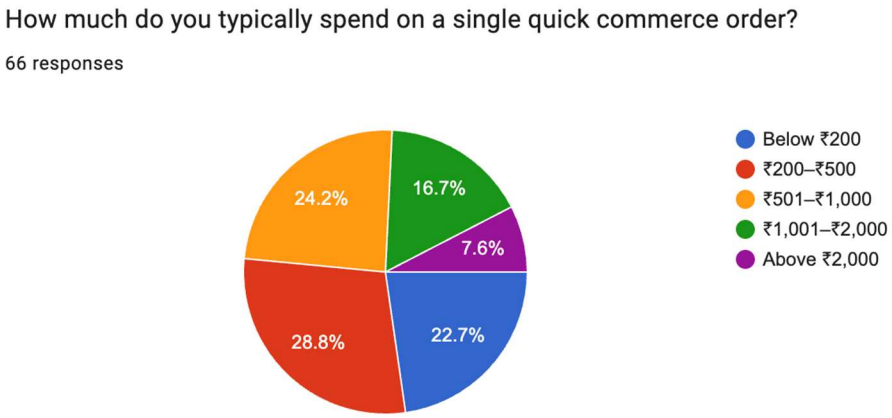


Fig. 4.f: Average Spend on a Single Quick Commerce Order

The largest share of respondents, 28.8 per cent, reported spending between ₹200 and ₹500 on a typical quick commerce order, while 22.7 per cent spend below ₹200 and 24.2 per cent spend between ₹501 and ₹1,000. A smaller but notable segment, amounting to 24.3 per cent of respondents collectively, reported spending above ₹1,000 per order, with 7.6 per cent spending above ₹2,000.

4.8 Products Purchased Most Frequently

Table 4.7: Products Purchased Most Frequently through Quick Commerce

Product Category	Number of Respondents	Percentage
Groceries	7	10.6%
Snacks and beverages	18	27.3%
Personal care products	16	24.2%
Household essentials	12	18.2%
Other products	13	19.7%
Total	**66**	**100.0%**

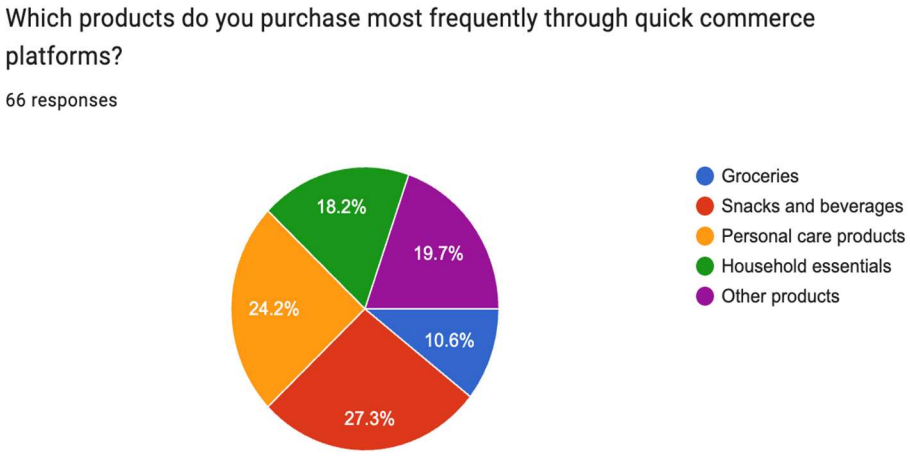


Fig. 4.g: Products Purchased Most Frequently through Quick Commerce

Snacks and beverages emerge as the most frequently purchased category, accounting for 27.3 per cent of responses, followed closely by personal care products at 24.2 per cent. Household essentials and other miscellaneous products account for 18.2 per cent and 19.7 per cent respectively, while core groceries represent the smallest share at 10.6 per cent.

4.9 Impact of Quick Commerce on Visits to Physical Retail Stores

Table 4.8: Impact of Quick Commerce on Visits to Physical Retail Stores

Response	Number of Respondents	Percentage
Significantly reduced	20	30.3%
Slightly reduced	19	28.8%
No change	12	18.2%
Increased physical store visits	5	7.6%
Not sure	10	15.2%
Total	**66**	**100.0%**

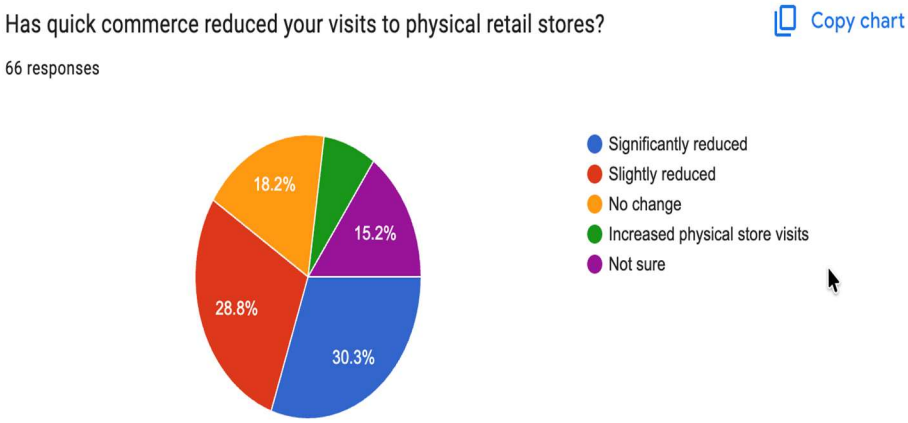


Fig. 4.h: Impact of Quick Commerce on Visits to Physical Retail Stores

A combined 59.1 per cent of respondents reported that their visits to physical retail stores have either significantly or slightly reduced since they began using quick commerce platforms, indicating a substantial displacement effect on traditional retail footfall. Only 7.6 per cent of respondents reported an increase in physical store visits, while 18.2 per cent observed no change and 15.2 per cent were unsure.

4.10 Importance of Fast Delivery in Purchasing Decisions

Table 4.9: Importance of Fast Delivery in Purchasing Decisions

Level of Importance	Number of Respondents	Percentage
Extremely important	17	25.8%
Very important	23	34.8%
Moderately important	17	25.8%
Slightly important	7	10.6%
Not important	2	3.0%
Total	**66**	**100.0%**

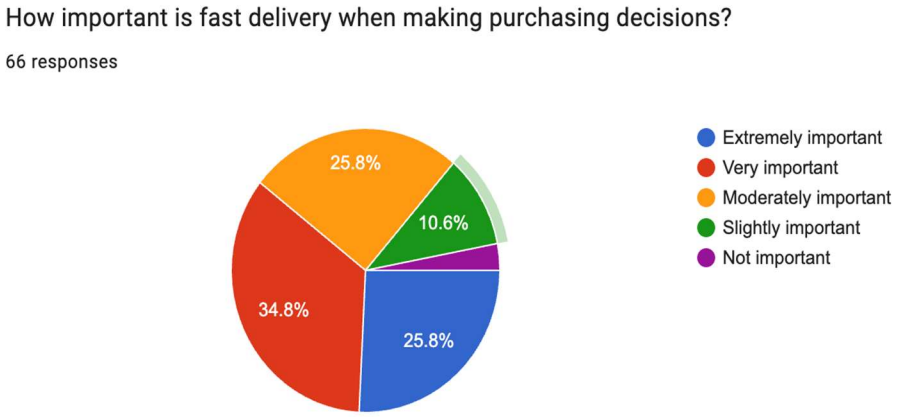


Fig. 4.i: Importance of Fast Delivery in Purchasing Decisions

A large majority of respondents, 60.6 per cent, rated fast delivery as either extremely important or very important to their purchasing decisions, while a further 25.8 per cent rated it as moderately important. Only 3.0 per cent of respondents considered fast delivery unimportant.

4.11 Influence of Discounts and Promotional Offers on Purchasing Decisions

Table 4.10: Influence of Discounts and Promotional Offers on Purchasing Decisions

Frequency of Influence	Number of Respondents	Percentage
Always	21	31.8%
Often	14	21.2%
Sometimes	21	31.8%
Rarely	6	9.1%
Never	4	6.1%
Total	**66**	**100.0%**

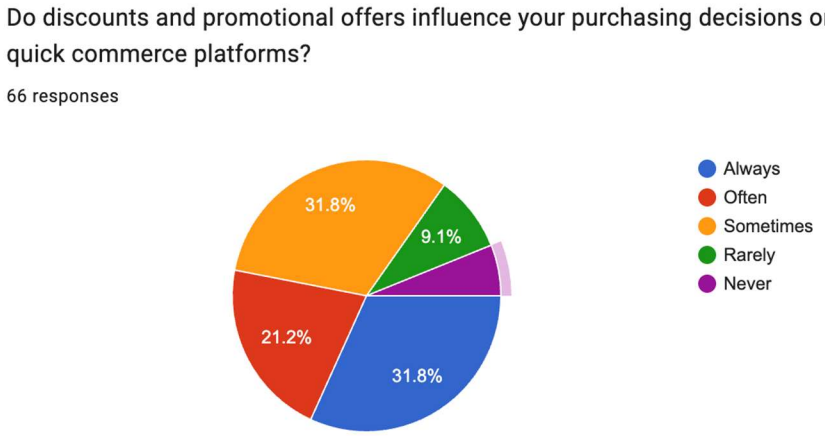


Fig. 4.j: Influence of Discounts and Promotional Offers on Purchasing Decisions

Discounts and promotional offers appear to exert a strong influence on purchasing decisions, with 31.8 per cent of respondents stating that such offers always influence their decisions and a further 21.2 per cent stating that they often do. Combined with the 31.8 per cent who are sometimes influenced, this suggests that price-based promotional mechanisms remain a powerful lever for driving purchase behaviour on quick commerce platforms,.

4.12 Impulsive Purchasing Behaviour on Quick Commerce Applications

Table 4.11: Impulsive Purchasing Behaviour on Quick Commerce Applications

Frequency of Impulsive Purchase	Number of Respondents	Percentage
Very frequently	10	15.2%
Frequently	24	36.4%
Sometimes	15	22.7%
Rarely	11	16.7%
Never	6	9.1%
Total	**66**	**100.0%**

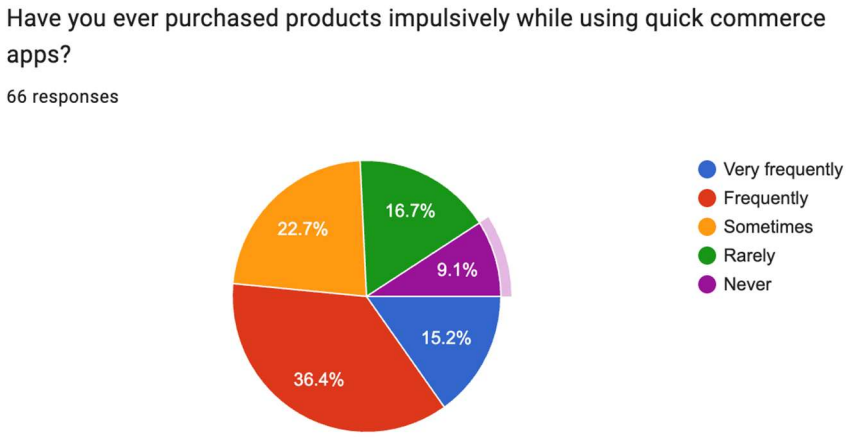


Fig. 4.k: Impulsive Purchasing Behaviour on Quick Commerce Applications

The data reveals that impulsive purchasing is a widespread phenomenon among quick commerce users, with 51.6 per cent of respondents reporting that they purchase impulsively either very frequently or frequently, and a further 22.7 per cent reporting that they do so sometimes. Only 9.1 per cent of respondents reported never making impulsive purchases on such platforms.

4.13 Impact of Quick Commerce on Overall Spending Behaviour

Table 4.12: Impact of Quick Commerce on Overall Spending Behaviour

Response	Number of Respondents	Percentage
Spending has increased significantly	17	25.8%
Spending has increased slightly	25	37.9%
No significant change	16	24.2%
Spending has decreased	4	6.1%
Not sure	4	6.1%
Total	**66**	**100.0%**

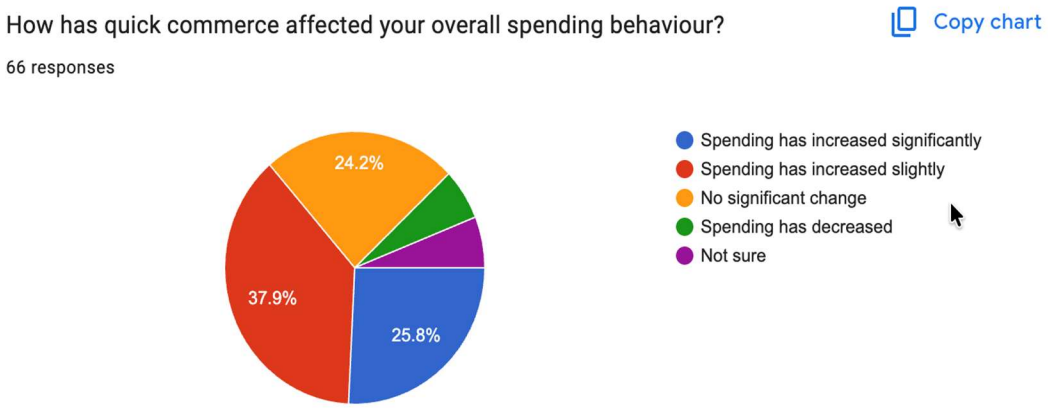


Fig. 4.l: Impact of Quick Commerce on Overall Spending Behaviour

A combined 63.7 per cent of respondents reported that their overall spending has increased, either significantly (25.8 per cent) or slightly (37.9 per cent), since they began using quick commerce platforms. Only 6.1 per cent reported a decrease in spending.

4.14 Overall Satisfaction with Quick Commerce Services

Table 4.13: Overall Satisfaction with Quick Commerce Services

Level of Satisfaction	Number of Respondents	Percentage
Very satisfied	12	18.2%
Satisfied	29	43.9%
Neutral	19	28.8%
Dissatisfied	5	7.6%
Very dissatisfied	1	1.5%
Total	**66**	**100.0%**

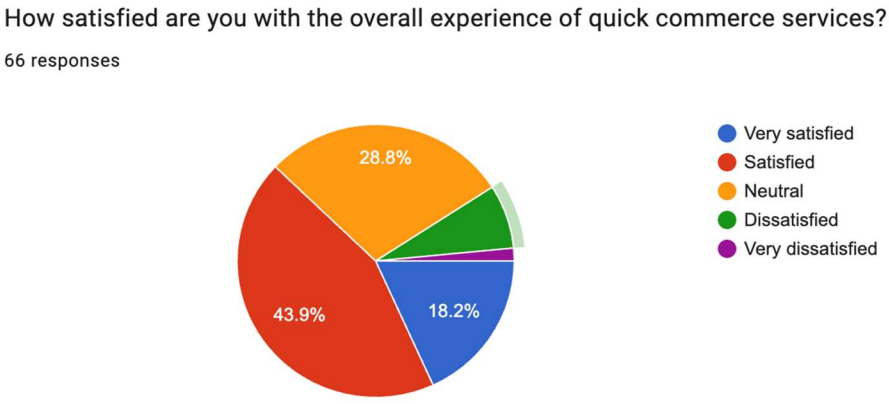


Fig. 4.m: Overall Satisfaction with Quick Commerce Services

The overall satisfaction levels reported by respondents are largely positive, with 62.1 per cent of respondents indicating that they are either very satisfied or satisfied with quick commerce services, while 28.8 per cent remain neutral. Only 9.1 per cent of respondents reported being dissatisfied or very dissatisfied.

4.15 Factors That Would Increase Frequency of Usage

Table 4.14: Factors That Would Increase Frequency of Usage

Factor	Number of Respondents	Percentage
Lower delivery charges	8	12.1%
Better discounts	22	33.3%
Faster delivery	15	22.7%
More product variety	18	27.3%
Better product quality	3	4.6%
Total	**66**	**100.0%**

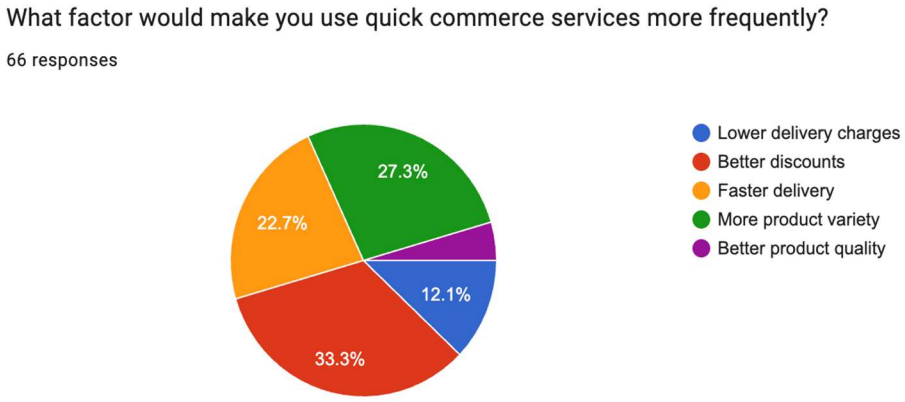


Fig. 4.n: Factors That Would Increase Frequency of Usage

Better discounts emerge as the most sought-after improvement, cited by 33.3 per cent of respondents, followed by more product variety at 27.3 per cent and faster delivery at 22.7 per cent. Lower delivery charges and better product quality were cited by 12.1 per cent and 4.6 per cent of respondents respectively.

4.16 Future Influence of Quick Commerce on Urban Consumer Behaviour

Table 4.15: Perceived Future Influence of Quick Commerce on Urban Consumer Behaviour

Response	Number of Respondents	Percentage
Strongly agree	19	28.8%
Agree	34	51.5%
Neutral	8	12.1%
Disagree	4	6.1%
Strongly disagree	1	1.5%
Total	**66**	**100.0%**

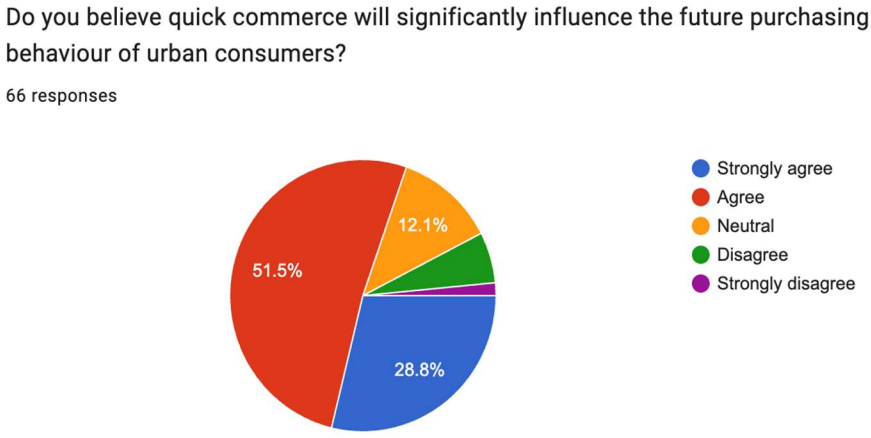


Fig. 4.o: Perceived Future Influence of Quick Commerce on Urban Consumer Behaviour

An overwhelming 80.3 per cent of respondents either strongly agree or agree that quick commerce will significantly influence the future purchasing behaviour of urban consumers, with only 7.6 per cent expressing disagreement.

4.18 Summary of Data Analysis

The analysis presented in this chapter reveals a consistent and coherent picture of quick commerce adoption among the surveyed urban consumers. Usage is frequent and widespread, driven primarily by the appeal of fast delivery, convenience and discounts. Average order values are modest but not insignificant, and spending on discretionary categories such as snacks, beverages and personal care products dominates over planned grocery purchases. A clear majority of respondents report reduced visits to physical retail stores, alongside a marked tendency towards impulsive purchasing and an overall increase in discretionary spending. Satisfaction levels are high, though price and product variety remain the most cited areas for improvement, and there is strong consensus among respondents that quick commerce will continue to shape urban consumer behaviour in the years ahead.

CHAPTER 5

FINDINGS, SUGGESTIONS AND CONCLUSION

5.1 FINDINGS OF THE STUDY

2 Most respondents, especially those aged 18–25, use quick commerce platforms at least once a week, showing that quick commerce is becoming part of regular shopping habits.

3 Swiggy Instamart is the most preferred platform, followed by Blinkit.

4 Fast delivery is the main reason for using quick commerce, followed by convenience and discounts.

5 Most respondents spend between ₹200 and ₹1,000 on a typical quick commerce order.

6 Snacks, beverages and personal care products are the most frequently purchased items.

7 About 59% of respondents said that their visits to physical retail stores have reduced after using quick commerce.

8 About 60.6% of respondents consider fast delivery extremely or very important when making purchases.

9 Discounts and promotional offers strongly influence the purchasing decisions of more than half of the respondents.

10 More than half of the respondents make impulse purchases frequently or very frequently while using quick commerce apps.

11 Nearly 64% of respondents said that their overall spending has increased after adopting quick commerce.

12 Overall satisfaction with quick commerce is high, with 62.1% of respondents being satisfied or very satisfied.

13 Better discounts, more product variety and faster delivery are the main factors that could encourage respondents to use quick commerce more often.

14 More than 80% of respondents believe that quick commerce will have a significant influence on the future purchasing behaviour of urban consumers.

5.2 Suggestions

Based on the findings of this study, the following suggestions are offered to quick commerce companies and related stakeholders:

1 Quick commerce platforms should provide attractive and targeted discounts while maintaining long-term financial sustainability.

2 Platforms should increase product variety, especially in personal care, household items and local products.

3 Platforms can provide budget alerts and spending reminders to help customers control unnecessary purchases.

4 Loyalty programmes and subscriptions can be introduced to reduce delivery costs for frequent users.

5 Local kirana stores and small retailers can explore partnerships with quick commerce platforms to reach more customers.

6 Platforms should maintain fast and reliable delivery, as delivery speed is highly important to customers.

7 Platforms should regularly collect customer feedback and take steps to improve areas causing dissatisfaction.

8 Platforms should improve product quality checks, including clear expiry dates and proper information about product substitutions.

9 Quick commerce platforms and local retailers can develop partnership models to reduce the impact on traditional retail businesses.

10 Platforms should use different strategies for different types of customers, such as urgent buyers, discount seekers and impulse buyers.

5.3 CONCLUSION

This study set out to examine the impact of quick commerce on the purchasing behaviour of urban consumers, with specific reference to usage frequency, motivations, spending patterns, product preferences, impact on physical retail visits, and overall satisfaction. The findings drawn from a survey of 66 urban respondents confirm that quick commerce has established itself as a significant and increasingly routine channel for urban consumption, driven primarily by the appeal of fast delivery, convenience and promotional discounts.

The study establishes that quick commerce has had a discernible impact on consumer behaviour along several dimensions. It has contributed to a reduction in footfall at physical retail stores, fostered a marked increase in impulsive purchasing tendencies, and been associated with an overall rise in discretionary spending among a majority of users. At the same time, overall satisfaction with the format remains high, and there is broad consensus among respondents that quick commerce will continue to shape the future of urban retail consumption.

These findings collectively affirm that quick commerce is not merely a transient pandemic-era or promotional phenomenon but represents a more structural shift in the manner in which urban Indian consumers fulfil their everyday purchasing needs. The objectives set out at the beginning of this study have been substantially met, and the insights generated offer a useful empirical

foundation for both academic researchers and industry practitioners seeking to understand this rapidly evolving segment of the retail economy.

Ultimately, the trajectory of quick commerce in urban India will likely be shaped by the interplay of several forces examined across this report: the continued strength of consumer demand for speed and convenience, documented empirically in Chapters Four and Five; the operational and financial sustainability challenges as well as the evolving regulatory environment discussed in Chapter Three; and the ongoing responses of traditional retail formats to the competitive pressure that quick commerce represents. This study sought to contribute to an informed understanding of the consumer-facing dimension of this interplay, and it is hoped that the findings and suggestions presented here will be of practical value to platform operators, policymakers and fellow researchers alike as the sector continues to evolve.

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APPENDIX

QUESTIONNAIRE

Impact of Quick Commerce on Purchasing Behaviour of Urban Consumers

Dear Respondent,

Please select the response that best represents your opinion or experience.

Please tick (✓) the appropriate option.

Section A: Demographic Information

1. What is your age group?

☐ Below 18 years

☐ 18–25 years

☐ 26–35 years

☐ 36–45 years

☐ Above 45 years

2. What is your gender?

☐ Male

☐ Female

☐ Prefer not to say

☐ Other

Section B: Quick Commerce Usage Behaviour

3. How often do you use quick commerce platforms such as Blinkit, Zepto, Swiggy Instamart, or BigBasket Now?

☐ Daily

☐ Several times a week

☐ Once a week

☐ Rarely

☐ Never

4. Which quick commerce platform do you use most frequently?

☐ Blinkit

☐ Zepto

☐ Swiggy Instamart

☐ BigBasket

☐ Other platforms

5. What is the primary reason for using quick commerce services?

☐ Fast delivery

☐ Convenience

☐ Discounts and offers

☐ Wide product availability

☐ Emergency or urgent requirements

6. How much do you typically spend on a single quick commerce order?

☐ Below ₹200

☐ ₹200–₹500

☐ ₹501–₹1,000

☐ ₹1,001–₹2,000

☐ Above ₹2,000

7. Which products do you purchase most frequently through quick commerce platforms?

☐ Groceries

☐ Snacks and beverages

☐ Personal care products

☐ Household essentials

☐ Other products

8. Has quick commerce reduced your visits to physical retail stores?

☐ Significantly reduced

☐ Slightly reduced

☐ No change

☐ Increased physical store visits

☐ Not sure

9. How important is fast delivery when making purchasing decisions?

☐ Extremely important

☐ Very important

☐ Moderately important

☐ Slightly important

☐ Not important

10. Do discounts and promotional offers influence your purchasing decisions on quick commerce platforms?

☐ Always

☐ Often

☐ Sometimes

☐ Rarely

☐ Never

11. Have you ever purchased products impulsively while using quick commerce apps?

☐ Very frequently

☐ Frequently

☐ Sometimes

☐ Rarely

☐ Never

12. How has quick commerce affected your overall spending behaviour?

☐ Spending has increased significantly

☐ Spending has increased slightly

☐ No significant change

☐ Spending has decreased

☐ Not sure

13. How satisfied are you with the overall experience of quick commerce services?

☐ Very satisfied

☐ Satisfied

☐ Neutral

☐ Dissatisfied

☐ Very dissatisfied

14. What factor would make you use quick commerce services more frequently?

☐ Lower delivery charges

☐ Better discounts

☐ Faster delivery

☐ More product variety

☐ Better product quality

15. Do you believe quick commerce will significantly influence the future purchasing behaviour of urban consumers?

☐ Strongly agree

☐ Agree

☐ Neutral

☐ Disagree

☐ Strongly disagree

16. Any other suggestions regarding branded and local products?

Thank you for your valuable time and cooperation. Your responses are highly valuable for the successful completion of this academic study…